Heat Stress – Quick Review

DID YOU KNOW…

Heat Stress is preventable and ignoring the warning signs of heat exposure may lead to a stroke?

- The four stages of Heat Exposure (least to most severe) are:
  - **Heat Fatigue** (heavy sweating and physical/mental exhaustion)
  - **Heat Cramps** (excessive sweating with cramps in abdomen or legs)
  - **Heat Exhaustion** (cool skin to touch, fatigue, nausea, cramping, dizziness, etc.)
  - **Heat Stroke** (hot skin to touch, unconsciousness, rapid pulse, confusion, etc.)
- If you notice these symptoms of heat stress, act immediately:
  - Move person(s) to a cooler location (shaded or indoors area with good circulation)
  - Increase water intake and spray, sponge or shower individual(s) with cool water
  - Loosen any tight clothing to help breathing
  - Call 911 immediately if the signs of Heat Stroke are present as medical attention is critical to prevent permanent loss or injury

… CDC notes an average of 658 heat-related deaths/year.

Take frequent breaks and cool off between jobs.

*Consume 1-2 bottles of water (16oz –32oz) **per hour** to stay hydrated during heat exposure.*



HSER MOMENT

Combatting Heat Stress

- Drink Plenty Of Cool Water
  - ½ your body weight in ounces
  - More if working outside
- Dress Appropriately
  - Lightweight clothing
- Work In Ventilated Areas
  - Avoid direct sunlight
- Rest Often
  - Frequent breaks in cool, shaded areas
  - Start work earlier in the day
- Know The Signs
  - Heat exhaustion and heat stroke
- Avoid Certain Drinks
  - Alcohol and caffeinated beverages
- Medications
  - Pay attention to any you are taking
    - Some affect the body's ability to stay hydrated





